

Digital Safety Transparency Report - Azure Online Services

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Reporting Period: February 17, 2024-December 31, 2024

Issued By: Microsoft Cloud + AI Engineering Group

Introduction

Microsoft Azure is Microsoft's brand name for a cloud computing platform on which Microsoft's organizational customers can build, deploy, and operate their chosen solutions and websites.

Microsoft Azure is a cloud computing platform that broadly conforms with the descriptions of cloud computing in both ISO/IEC 22123-1:2023 (ISO 22123) and NIST Special Publication 800-145 (SP 800-145).

Microsoft Azure comprises a catalog of cloud services that operate under a common authentication, policy, operations management, and commercial framework which are configured by each customer to realize their solution design.

As a backend services provider, Microsoft Azure enables organizational customers to brand their websites and services to their own end users as their own, which is the typical deployment. Organizational customers are responsible for the content on websites and services they deploy using Microsoft Azure, in line with Microsoft policy on acceptable uses and treatment of enterprise customer data.

Contents

This Digital Safety Transparency Report covers two categories of Microsoft Azure service offerings:

Category	Description
Azure Infrastructure and Platform Services	The Azure services that organizational customers configure and use to operate functional websites and solutions that they manage and operate.
Azure Development Tools and Services	The software development work management tools used by organizational customers to design, build, and test their software to be used in the cloud, or on customer systems.

This Transparency Report is responsive to the obligations under DSA Article 15(1), Article 24(1), and Article 42(2)-(3). This Report provides information regarding the following topics as they pertain to the European Union:

[Content Moderation at Microsoft's Initiative](#)
[Content Moderation & Automated Systems](#)
[Content Moderation following a User Report](#)
[Government Requests](#)

Content Moderation at Microsoft's Initiative

Microsoft provides the information below in response to DSA Article 15(1)(c). This section reports data regarding content moderation Azure engaged in on its own initiative, absent a user report.

Microsoft Azure did not engage in content moderation as defined by the DSA on its own initiative during the reporting period. Microsoft solely acts as a backend processing service on customers' behalf, who may implement content moderation systems on their data if they choose.

Content Moderation & Automated Systems

Microsoft provides the information below in response to DSA Articles 15(1)(e) and 42(2)(c).

During the reporting period, Microsoft Azure did not use automated means for the purpose of "content moderation" as that term is defined by the Digital Services Act.

Content Moderation following a User Report

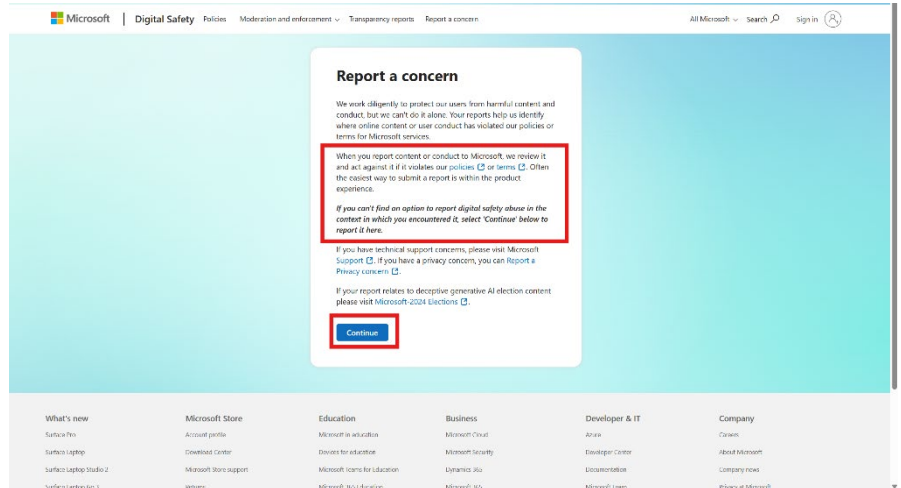
Microsoft provides the information below in response to DSA Articles 15(1)(b)-(c) and 41(2)(a)-(b).

Organizational customers implement their own policies for acceptable activity, content, and use of their finished technology solutions and are responsible for managing those. Their users typically follow those policies and use facilities the organizational customer has provided. While it is possible that a user or administrator may identify Microsoft as hosting the customer's solution on the back end, this happens extremely rarely. An organizational user or administrator who wants to report a content concern to Microsoft can do so by going to the landing page for Microsoft Digital Safety <https://www.microsoft.com/digitalsafety> and following the steps below.

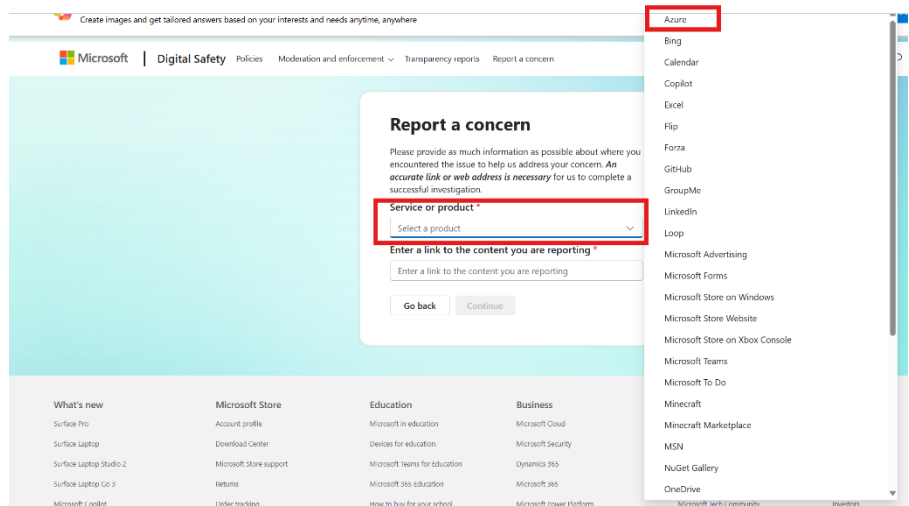
1. Go to **"Report a concern"**

The screenshot shows the Microsoft Digital Safety website. At the top, there is a navigation bar with links for Microsoft, Digital Safety, Policies, Moderation and enforcement, Transparency reports, and Report a concern. The main heading is 'Digital Safety at Microsoft' with a subtext: 'Microsoft works to preserve digital safety while respecting human rights like privacy, freedom of speech, and security. Safe online spaces help people create, connect, and share knowledge.' Below this is a section for 'Safer Internet Day 2024 – Global Online Safety Survey results now available' with a 'See the results' button. The 'Report a concern' form is visible, with a dropdown menu for 'Service or product' set to 'Azure'. A red box highlights a warning message: 'Reporting concerns for Azure. Azure users must report concerns in Azure so that we can effectively identify and review the concern. Learn how to report a concern'.

2. If there is not a "Report a concern" option in the product in question, click **Continue**.

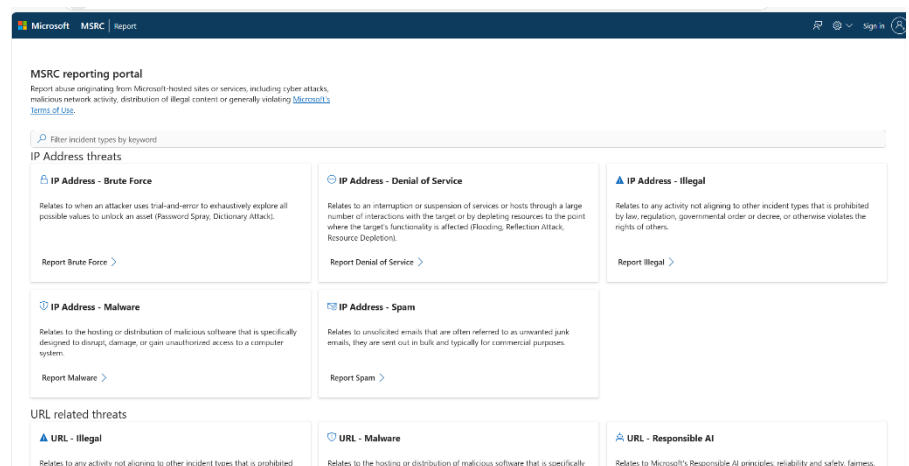


3. Select a product "**Azure**"



4. "Report a concern" is routed to the Microsoft Security Response Center reporting portal. (Reporters can also go directly to MSRC reporting portal at <https://msrc.microsoft.com/report/>)

5. Select applicable harm (**IP Address - Brute Force** used as example)



6. Complete the harm specific webform that is displayed and provide relevant content to facilitate review. Make sure to scroll through all webform fields, then click **Submit**.
7. Reporter receives email notification acknowledging receipt of reported abuse.
8. Once review has been completed, the reporter will receive an email notice with the result of review.

In most cases the user/reporter will not be able to provide sufficient identifying information to allow the Azure service subscription to be identified because the organizational customer through whose service provision or website the reporter encountered the content will appear as the main provider, rather than Microsoft as the backend provider. The reporter will be informed of no Microsoft action and advised to contact their organizational administrator or digital safety contact. However, where possible and if necessary, in Microsoft's determination, Microsoft will contact the organization's designated contact for the Azure cloud service and alert them to the user's report. If the user has not selected anonymous reporting, we may provide the customer the contact details for the reporting user.

The organizational customer is responsible for content mitigation and communication with their users on the mitigation expectations as determined by their organization. Organizational customers do not notify Microsoft of reports they receive directly.

User-Selected Report Reason	Total Number of Reports	Content Was Moderated	Description
Intellectual Property Infringement	3	0	Microsoft provided the reports to the relevant organizational customers for their attention.

Government Requests

Microsoft provides the information below in response to DSA Article 15(1)(a).

Azure received 0 (zero) orders from government authorities to act against alleged illegal content during the reporting period.

Member State	Total Government Requests	Request Granted
N/A	0	0